



Incident handler's journal

Date: July 23, 2024	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	● Who: An organized group of unethical hackers ● What: A ransomware security incident ● Where: At a health care company ● When: Tuesday 9:00 a.m. ● Why: The incident happened because unethical hackers were able to access the company's systems using a phishing attack. After gaining access, the attackers launched their ransomware on the company's systems, encrypting critical files. The attackers' motivation appears to be financial because the ransom note they left demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.
Additional notes	1. The organization should implement regular cybersecurity awareness training to educate employees about phishing attacks, enforce multi-factor authentication (MFA), apply timely security updates and patches, maintain offline and tested backups, deploy endpoint detection and response (EDR) solutions, and implement email filtering to reduce malicious emails reaching users. Regular risk assessments and incident response exercises would also strengthen the organization's security posture. 2. Generally, paying the ransom is not recommended. Payment does not guarantee that the attackers will provide a working decryption key or refrain from future attacks. Instead, the organization should isolate affected systems, restore data from secure backups, notify relevant authorities, and follow its incident response plan while conducting a full investigation to prevent similar incidents in the future.